Law to take the throne of France away from his niece, he had inadvertently provided a way for the English king to take the French thone. Philip V's end run around his niece's right to rule France had led to the barring of his own daughter, his sole child, from the throne, and the appointment of the new House of Valois in the place of Hugh Capet's descendants—leaving Edward III, son of Philip's sister Isabelle, as the sole remaining monarch of direct Capetian descent.

Edward III prepared for war by recruiting an ally: Louis IV of Germany. Louis agreed to declare Edward III the Vicar-General of the Holy Roman Empire, "so that all those of the Empire should be at his service." This would give the English king the right to recruit soldiers from anywhere in the empire; but before the declaration could be made, Louis IV needed to make very clear that he had the right to make it.[8]



71.1 The Start of the Hundred Years' War

In a series of three meetings held over the spring and summer of 1338, the electors of Germany agreed, almost unanimously (John of Bohemia, Louis's longtime enemy, dissented), to put down in writing, as an imperial policy, the